To give it a lighter texture, this yeast-free bread is made with buttermilk rather than plain milk. For brown soda bread, replace half or all the white flour with wholemeal flour.

soda bread

MAKES 6 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 30–35 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 6 MONTHS

3¼ cups bread flour, plus extra for dusting
2 tsp baking soda
2 tsp cream of tartar
1 tsp salt
4 tbsp butter or lard, diced
1¼ cups buttermilk or 1¼ cups whole milk mixed with 1 tsp cider vinegar

1 Preheat the oven to 425°F (220°C). Dust a baking sheet with flour. Sift the flour, baking soda, cream of tartar, and salt together into a bowl. Add the butter and rub in with your fingertips to form fine crumbs.

2 Make a well in the center. Pour in the buttermilk and then mix to form a soft dough. Knead briefly on a lightly floured work surface. Shape into a ball, then roll on the work surface to smooth the surface.

3 Place on the baking sheet, and lightly flatten the top. Using a floured knife, cut into 6 equal wedges, without completely cutting all the way through the dough.

4 Bake for 30–35 minutes, or until golden brown and the bread sounds hollow when tapped on the bottom. Transfer to a wire rack and let cool.